

NAPCS Unionization Research — State — Charter School Overview

North Carolina — NLRB R11 Jurisdiction — June 6, 2026 [RESEARCH DEFERRED]

NAPCS Unionization Research • June 6, 2026 • Template v8.0 • TIER 2D — RESEARCH DEFERRED

Section 1: State Overview

State	North Carolina
Labor Board	NLRB R11 — National Labor Relations Board, Region 11 (Winston-Salem)
Governing Law	N.C. Gen. Stat. §115C-218 et seq. (Charter Schools Act). N.C.G.S. §95-98 bans collective bargaining agreements with governmental units — charter schools are classified as private employers for labor law purposes. NLRB R11 jurisdiction.
Federal NLRB Jurisdiction	YES — N.C.G.S. §95-98 prohibits governmental CB agreements — charters are private employers under NLRB R11.
Right-to-Work	Right-to-Work State — N.C. Gen. Stat. §95-78 through §95-84
For-Profit Operator Status	For-profit EMO management contracts permitted under state law
Card-Check Available	NO — RTW state; no card-check statute. §95-98 bars governmental CB.
Research Status	DEFERRED — Executive Sponsor direction, June 7, 2026 (PDR-018). Charter schools assumed unorganized. No school-level research conducted.

Section 2: Charter School Landscape

Research deferred — Executive Sponsor direction (PDR-018, June 7, 2026). Charter schools assumed unorganized. Charter universe and enrollment figures are sourced from Charter School Registry v133 and NCES ELSI 2024–25. No school-level research has been conducted.

Category	Schools	% of Total	Notes
No Organizing Activity Documented	213	100%	Research deferred — Executive Sponsor direction (PDR-018, June 7, 2026). Charter schools assumed unorganized.
Total Charter Schools in North Carolina	213	100%	Source: Charter School Registry v133 (NCES ELSI 2024–25).

Charter School Enrollment

Total Charter Enrollment	153,008 students — 9.8% of state K–12 enrollment (1,555,418 total K–12 students)
Students in CMO/EMO-Affiliated Charter Schools	N/A — research deferred; charter schools assumed unorganized
Students in Organized Charter Schools	N/A — research deferred; charter schools assumed unorganized
Data Sources	Charter enrollment: NCES ELSI 2024–25 / Charter School Registry v133. Total K–12 state enrollment: NCES ELSI 2024–25 (all public schools). Both figures from the same source and year.

Section 3: Charter Management Organizations & Education Management Organizations

Charter Management Organizations (CMOs) are nonprofit networks. Education Management Organizations (EMOs) are for-profit management companies. Data sourced from Charter School Registry v133. Union penetration reflects confirmed organized schools as of the data currency date.

CMO / EMO Name	Type	State Campuses	National Campuses †	Organized in State	Total Enrollment
KIPP North Carolina	Network‡	4	—	—	2,864
Ascend Leadership Academy	Network‡	2	—	—	655
Voyager Academy	Network‡	2	—	—	1,560
North East Carolina Preparatory School	Network‡	2	—	—	1,107
Pine Springs Preparatory Academy	Network‡	2	—	—	3,810
Telra Institute	Network‡	2	—	—	621
Uwharrie Charter Academy	Network‡	2	—	—	2,257
Carolina Charter Academy (CFA)	Network‡	1	—	—	782
Longleaf School of the Arts	Network‡	1	—	—	405
TOTAL — All CMO/EMO Schools in North Carolina		18		—	14,061
of which organized				—	—

Total enrollment shown is the combined enrollment of all CMO/EMO network schools in North Carolina. Organized network schools: 0 organized schools in network-affiliated charters.

† National Campuses reflects total campuses operated by this network across all states, as reported in Charter School Registry v133. Provides context for networks operating in multiple states.

‡ Network (type unclassified) = operator present in Charter School Registry v133 but not yet classified in CMO Reference data. Contact registry project to add classification for these records.

9 network (type unclassified). Approximately 195 schools operate independently with no CMO/EMO affiliation. Source: Charter School Registry v133.

Section 4: Legal Framework & Charter School Overview

Findings are based on research as of June 6, 2026.

1: Legal & Jurisdictional Framework

N.C. Gen. Stat. §115C-218 et seq. (Charter Schools Act). N.C.G.S. §95-98 bans collective bargaining agreements with governmental units — charter schools are classified as private employers for labor law purposes. NLRB R11 jurisdiction. North Carolina is a right-to-work state (N.C. Gen. Stat. §95-78 through §95-84). Charter schools in North Carolina are subject to NLRB jurisdiction as private employers (NLRB R11). Secret ballot NLRB election is the required organizing pathway. Card-check is not available.

2: Charter School Structure

North Carolina operates 213 open-enrollment charter schools, enrolling approximately 153,008 students. 9 charter management organizations and education management organizations operate in North Carolina. The largest networks by campus count are KIPP North Carolina (4 campuses in state), Ascend Leadership Academy (2 campuses in state), Voyager Academy (2 campuses in state). Approximately 195 schools operate independently with no CMO or EMO affiliation. Network-level detail, including campus counts and total enrollment, appears in Section 3 above. No school-level union research has been conducted. Research deferred

— Executive Sponsor direction (PDR-018, June 7, 2026).

Section 5: Media Coverage & Public Stakeholder Positions

Press Coverage

No press coverage of charter school employee organizing has been identified in North Carolina. charter school community coverage focuses on growth, authorizer oversight, and school performance accountability.

Legislative Context

No charter school community collective bargaining legislation has been introduced in the North Carolina General Assembly. The §95-98 government CB prohibition does not apply to charter schools as private employers. No legislative proposals addressing charter employee labor relations have been identified.

Section 6: Contract & CBA Access Registry

No collective bargaining agreements documented for this state. Research deferred — charter schools assumed unorganized (PDR-018, June 7, 2026).